

THE BLACK PANTHER

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Smiling Chicago police carry out the body of slain Black Panther Party leader FRED HAMPTON (inset) after they murdered him in his sleep in a December 4, 1969, predawn raid. A COINTELPRO document recently released in Chicago reveals that the FBI proudly took "credit" for this murder.

(Chicago, Ill.) - The Chicago office of the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) claimed "credit" for the murders of Illinois State Black Panther Party leaders Fred Hampton and Mark Clark a few days after the December 4, 1969, predawn raid in which the pair were killed by police gunfire.

Proof of FBI responsibility for the raid, contained in a self-glorifying letter to late FBI czar J. Edgar Hoover, is just one of several shocking disclosures revealed in FBI COINTELPRO documents recently released to the plaintiffs in the \$47.7 million Fred Hampton murder case. These COINTELPRO documents, the subject of ongoing stormy debate during the course of the trial, were withheld for months by the FBI and their U.S. Justice Department attorneys despite repeated court orders.

Among the other revelations contained in the documents are: that, in 1969, when he was a state official, present Cook County State's Attorney Bernard Carey intercepted 21 private letters mailed to Fred Hampton while he was a prisoner at Menard State Prison and provided copies of this mail to the FBI; that the FBI began an undercover surveillance campaign against Hampton in 1967 when he was a 19-year-old NAACP youth leader in suburban Maywood, Illinois; that even more COINTELPRO documents are being withheld by the 28 law enforcement defendants in the case.

The existence of the continuing cover-up was revealed in an additional statement "concerning concealment of evidence by the

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